How I Make Waking Up at 4 A.M. Easier

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Nov 14, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/THWLSBrJRak Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter's "cheat code" for consistent 4 AM wake-ups combines a physical forcing function (pre-workout across the room), adequate sleep, and leveraging the distraction-free early morning for focused, high-priority work.

📑 Contents

- 🚨 The Night-Before Setup
- 😴 Sleep Rules and Flexibility
- 🌅 Why Early Rising Works

🚨 The Night-Before Setup 0:00

- Set the phone alarm the night before
- Mix up your favorite pre-workout drink and place it on the **other side of the bedroom**
  - This forces you to physically get out of bed to turn off the alarm
  - The pre-workout is waiting as an immediate reward/incentive once you're up
- These two steps together remove the option to lazily silence the alarm and roll back over

😴 Sleep Rules and Flexibility 0:00

- To wake at 4 AM, you must go to sleep early the night before — no exceptions
- Minimum sleep target: **7 hours**
- Carter pushes back on the "same schedule every single day" dogma
  - If the body needs more sleep, he takes more sleep
  - Reasoning: "Health is the most important thing. If your body's not functioning, you're not going to be out here getting money."
- Flexibility around total sleep duration is acceptable; protecting sleep quality is non-negotiable

🌅 Why Early Rising Works 0:22

- 4 AM is valuable because almost no one else is awake — meaning no one is competing for your time or attention yet
- You can concentrate on your **most important task** completely uninterrupted

- Many successful people wake up early for exactly this reason
  - Carter notes some successful people do sleep in, acknowledging it isn't universal
- The core logic: get critical work done before the world wakes up and starts making demands on you